engine for an indigenously developed supersonic jet. Indian military officers who preferred Western options had approached Defense Department officials about how to get around the defense minister.[218]

The military supply question had not been discussed during Nehru's subsequent visit to the US. Before he had arrived, however, the administration had decided to consider Indian requests for dual-purpose equipment against China. After Nehru's trip, when it had become clear that a Soviet military sales mission was expected in India, there had been a push to convey to Indian officials that the US was open for business. This effort had stalled, however, because of the Indian takeover of Goa in December.[219]

In summer 1962, when India seemed close to an agreement to acquire Soviet MiGs, US officials tried to dissuade India. Galbraith emphasized the adverse impact on US opinion and legislation, and stressed that the rupee payment terms of the deal made it military aid by the Indian definition.[220] In Washington, Komer argued that the US should protest "for effect," but not try to match the Soviet offer. Purchases from Moscow might actually give India some confidence of Soviet neutrality in the Sino-Indian dispute and make Delhi more resolute. Moreover, given the imminent UN discussion on Kashmir and the US need to keep Pakistan from extreme action, it was not the right time to signal that the US was "shifting to a pro-Indian stance." Finally, he argued, India was unlikely to want Moscow as its sole supplier, and would try to find a way to balance the purchase with a Western one.[221]

Galbraith, who believed that India was going to buy modern equipment to counter the Chinese threat, wanted to be more forward leaning. He felt the US should find a way to check greater Soviet influence, especially as Nehru's future was uncertain and a new leader might move leftward.[222] The administration, along with Britain, tried to come up with an alternate "spoiling offer" to the MiGs, even if it was just for the record.[223] But after Indian finance minister Tiruvellore Thattai (T. T.) Krishnamachari suggested to Galbraith that the linking of the China and Pakistan threats in cabinet members' minds made a deal with Moscow imminent,[224] Kennedy decided to stop objecting to the purchase.[225]

"Indians to Arms"

The situation on the China front had indeed deteriorated by summer 1962. In spring 1962, India had started implementing a "forward policy,"